

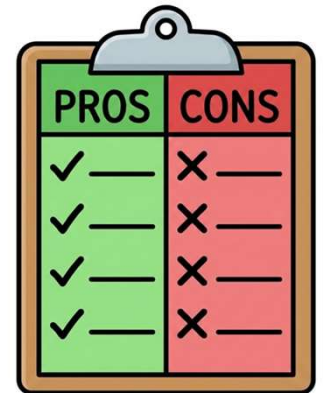
Procurement Strategy

Group 8

A. Gafoor, K. Snow, A. Balkarran, M. Kayode

Decision Framework | Multi-Criteria Decision Analysis (MCDA)

- MCDA is a structured decision making framework used to evaluate and rank multiple decisions based on specific criteria.
- Core Components:
 - Decision alternatives: Options being evaluated
 - Criteria: Factors used to assess alternatives
 - Weights: Relative importance assigned to each criterion
 - Stakeholders: Decision-makers whose preferences guide the evaluation
- Process:
 1. Define the decision and alternatives
 2. Select evaluation criteria
 3. Rate each alternative
 4. Assign weights to criteria
 5. Sum up scores to determine best alternative



MCDA Matrix | Streamlined Reporting

Decision Outcome

- Streamlined Reporting selected as the digital transformation initiative
- Highest MCDA score: **3.8**

Why it matters?

- Reporting inefficiencies were identified as a major operational bottleneck.
- Manual data consolidation slowed decision-making.
- Digital reporting platforms enable real-time insights and enterprise data governance.

Streamlined reporting scored highest due to strong strategic value, scalability, and manageable implementation difficulty.

Scale: 1 = Very Low | 2 = Low | 3 = Moderate | 4 = High | 5 = Very High

Criteria	Weights	Land Acquisition	Timesheet Enhancement	Streamlined Reporting
<i>Risk Reduction</i>	0.10	4	4	3
<i>Strategic Value</i>	0.30	3	2	5
<i>Operational Efficiency</i>	0.20	4	4	3
<i>Implementation Difficulty</i>	0.15	5	3	5
<i>Scalability</i>	0.10	5	5	5
<i>Cultural Readiness</i>	0.15	1	1	1
Totals	1	3.5	2.9	3.8

Total = Score X Weight

Procurement | Evaluation Criteria

Scale: 1 = Poor Fit | 2 = Weak Fit | 3 = Moderate Fit | 4 = Good Fit | 5 = Strong Fit

- Strategic alignment weighted highest due to need to support total enterprise data strategy
- Security and Scalability are prioritized due to growing data footprint
- Cost is on the lower end because long term capability matters more than short-term savings

Criteria	Weight (%)	Why it Matters
<i>Strategic Alignment</i>	20	<i>Ensures the technology investment directly supports specific business goals rather than being a standalone IT project</i>
<i>Security & Compliance</i>	15	<i>Protects the organization from data breaches, legal liabilities, and ensures adherence to industry-specific regulations.</i>
<i>Scalability</i>	15	<i>Ensures the system can handle future growth in users and data volume without requiring a complete architectural overhaul.</i>
<i>Integration with existing systems</i>	10	<i>Determines how easily the new solution communicates with existing systems to eliminate manual data silos.</i>
<i>User Experience</i>	10	<i>Directly impacts the adoption rate; if a tool is difficult to use, employees will revert to old, inefficient manual processes.</i>
<i>Implementation Timeline</i>	10	<i>Determines how quickly the business can expect a return on its capital and labour investment.</i>
<i>Customization Flexibility</i>	5	<i>Allows the solution to be tailored to unique, proprietary business logic that standard "out-of-the-box" tools cannot handle.</i>
<i>Vendor Stability/ Reputation</i>	5	<i>Mitigates long-term risk by ensuring the provider will continue to support, update, and secure the platform for years to come</i>
<i>Change Management</i>	5	<i>Identifies the level of training (and cultural shift) required to ensure the workforce successfully transitions to the new system</i>
<i>Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)</i>	5	<i>Provides a view of both up front costs and long-term operating expenses to ensure sustainable profitability.</i>

Market Options

1. Microsoft Fabric
 - A unified data platform for enterprise analytics
2. Databricks
 - An advanced data engineering and AI platform
3. Amazon AWS
 - A scalable cloud data infrastructure
4. SAP Crystal Reports
 - An enterprise reporting tool for structured reports





Microsoft Fabric

Microsoft Fabric | Background & Market Presence

Overview

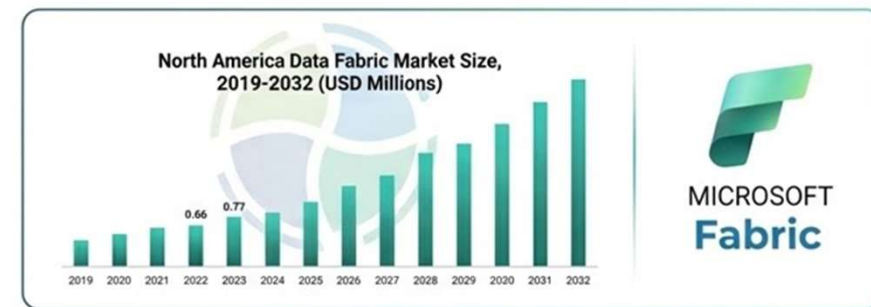
- Microsoft is a global technology leader that provides a comprehensive ecosystem of AI-powered productivity software, cloud infrastructure, and unified data platforms.
- Microsoft Fabric serves digital transformation as a "complete data platform" that brings together several data-related workloads under a single architecture.

Industry Specialization

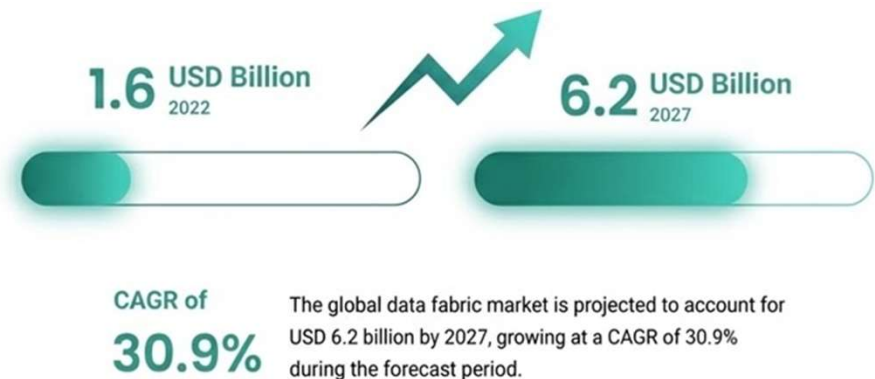
- The platform is already being utilized across diverse sectors.

Market Presence

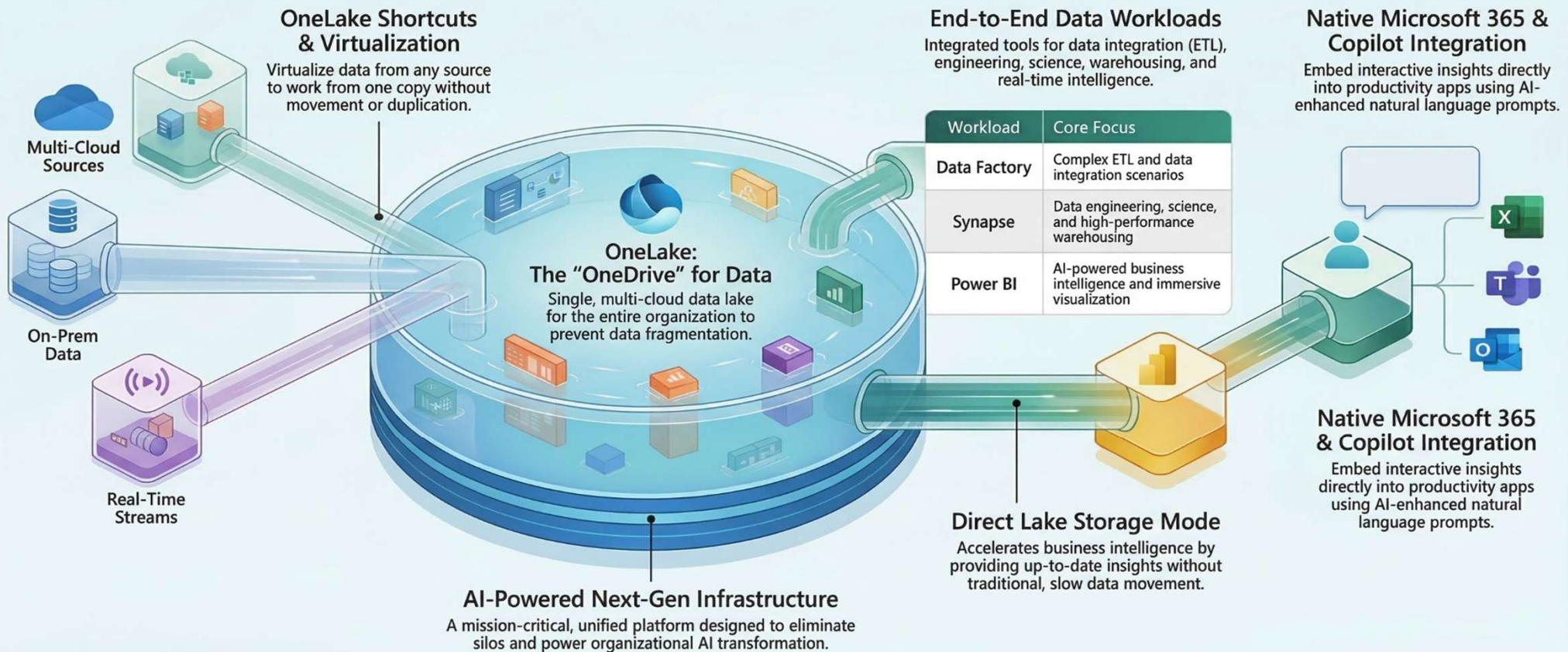
- Fabric is positioned as a "next generation" platform that provides a mission-critical infrastructure for global organizations.



Data Fabric Market Overview



Microsoft Fabric: The Unified AI-Powered Data Ecosystem



Microsoft Fabric | Background & Market Presence

Cost Structure

- Organizations use a tiered price plan based on user needs, starting at F2 \$399.53 CAD and incentivized for term commitments with ~41% saving.



Strengths

- Current Users of Microsoft 365
- Consolidate multiple data tools into one
- Reduce Data Prep and refresh issues
- Governed Enterprise reporting
- Open Ecosystem
- Focus on Creating a "Data Culture"



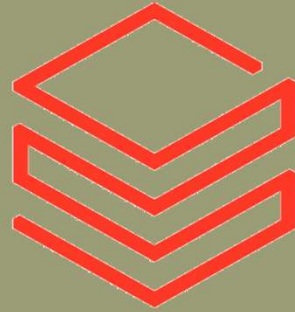
Demo / Trial Observations

- A free trial is available where users receive a fixed amount of capacity

Risks

- Capacity Estimator for costs
- Steep Learning Curve for small orgs
- Some technical training needed

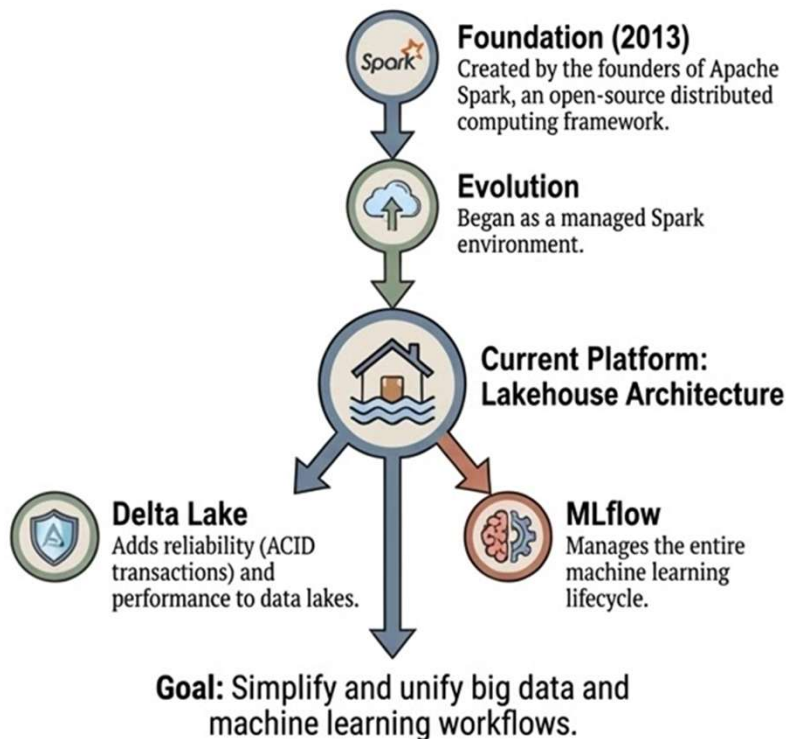




databricks

Databricks | Background & Market Presence

Background



Market Presence



> \$5.4

Revenue Run-Rate: > \$5.4 Billion USD



> 65%

Growth: > 65% Year-over-Year



> 20,000

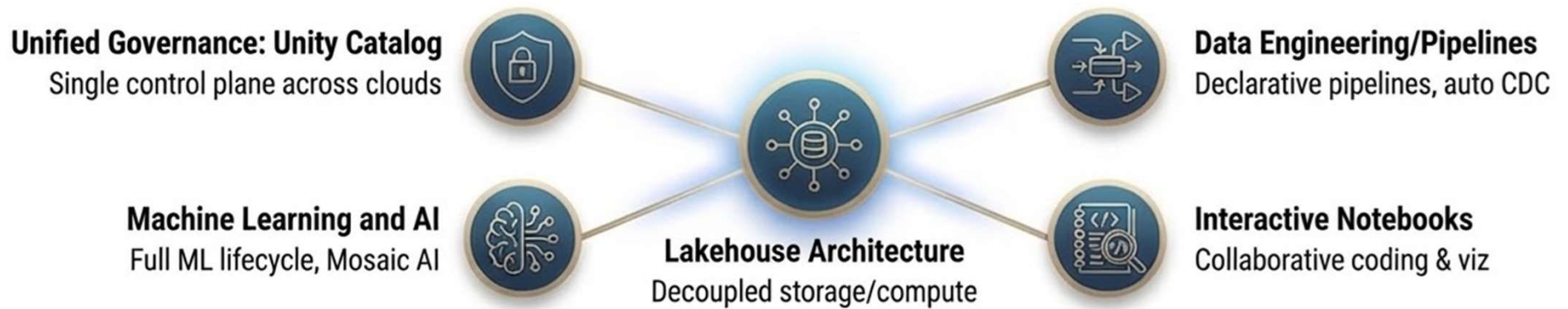
Customers: > 20,000 organizations (including > 60% of the Fortune 500).



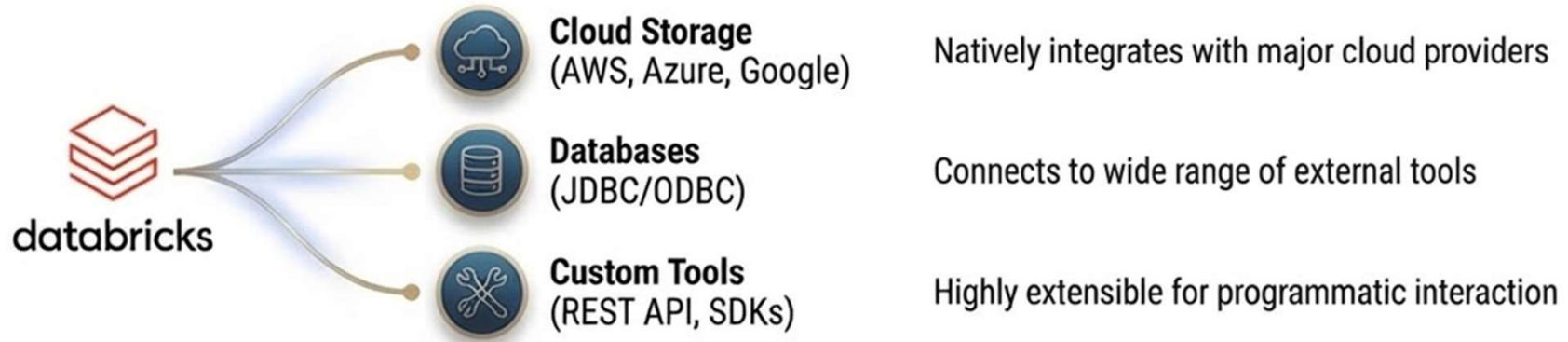
Competition

Competition: Competes with platforms like Snowflake and Microsoft Fabric.

Databricks | Core Capabilities and Competitive Edge



Differentiators (AI-Native, Open, Automated): Integration



Databricks | Unified Platform & Cost Structure Overview

Unified Data & AI Platform Advantages



Unified Data & AI Platform

Integrates data engineering, data science, and AI into a single collaborative environment, eliminating silos and accelerating time-to-insight.



Optimized Performance & Reliability

Enhanced Databricks Runtime for faster processing than standard Spark, with standard Spark with Delta Lake ensuring data flow, security, consistency and quality.



Multi-Cloud Versatility

Provides a consistent consistent experience across AWS, Azure, GCP) in deep native service integration.



Extensive Open Ecosystem

Seamlessly integrates with popular third-party tools (e.g. BI (e.g. Tableau), orchestration (orchestration (e.g.. TensorFlow, and ML TensorFlow).

Cost Structure & Pricing (DBU Model)



Data Engineering
\$0.15/DBU



Data Warehousing
\$0.22/DBU



Interactive Workloads
\$0.40/DBU



Artificial Intelligence
\$0.07/DBU

Factors Influencing Total Cost



Regional Variations: The price per DBU and the underlying cloud.



Committed Use Contracts: Organization can access discount benefits to specific usage levels.

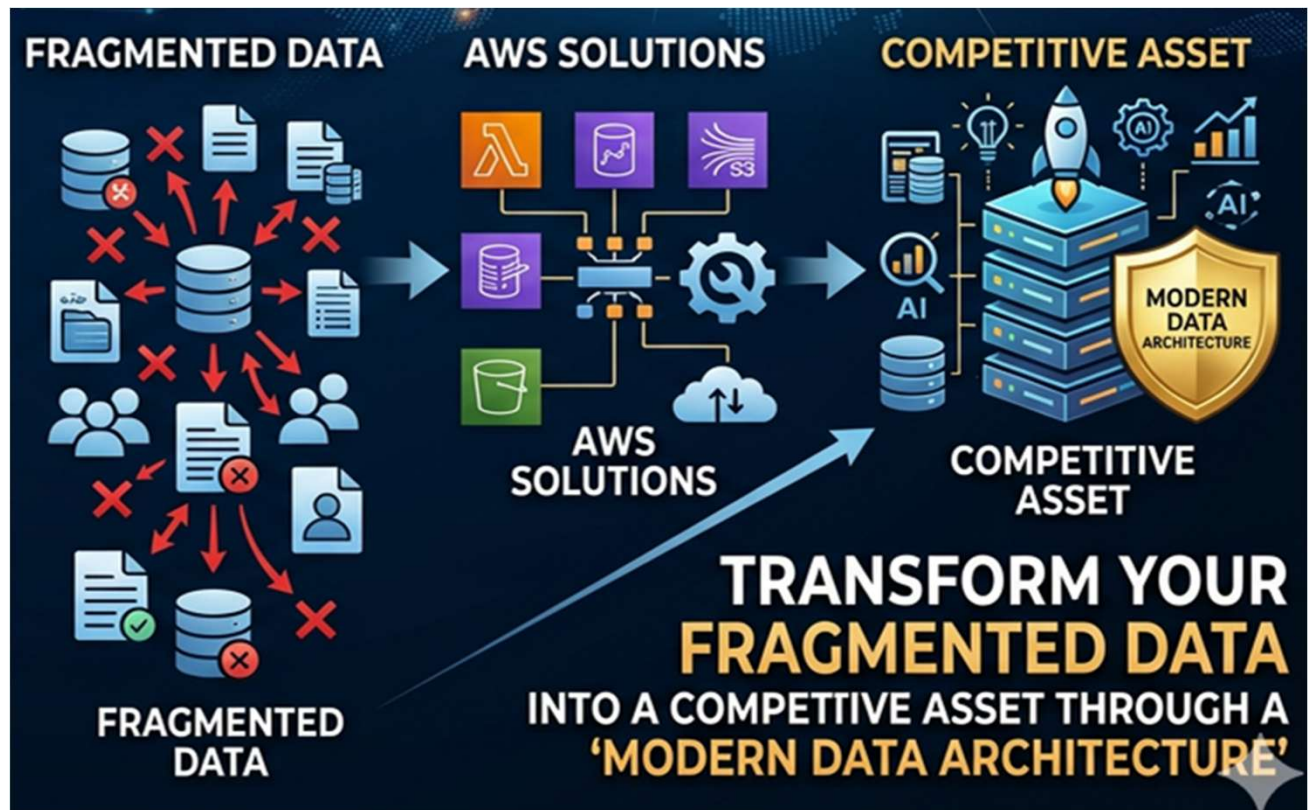


Infrastructure Costs: DBU pricing software the Databricks provider for compute, storage, and networking.

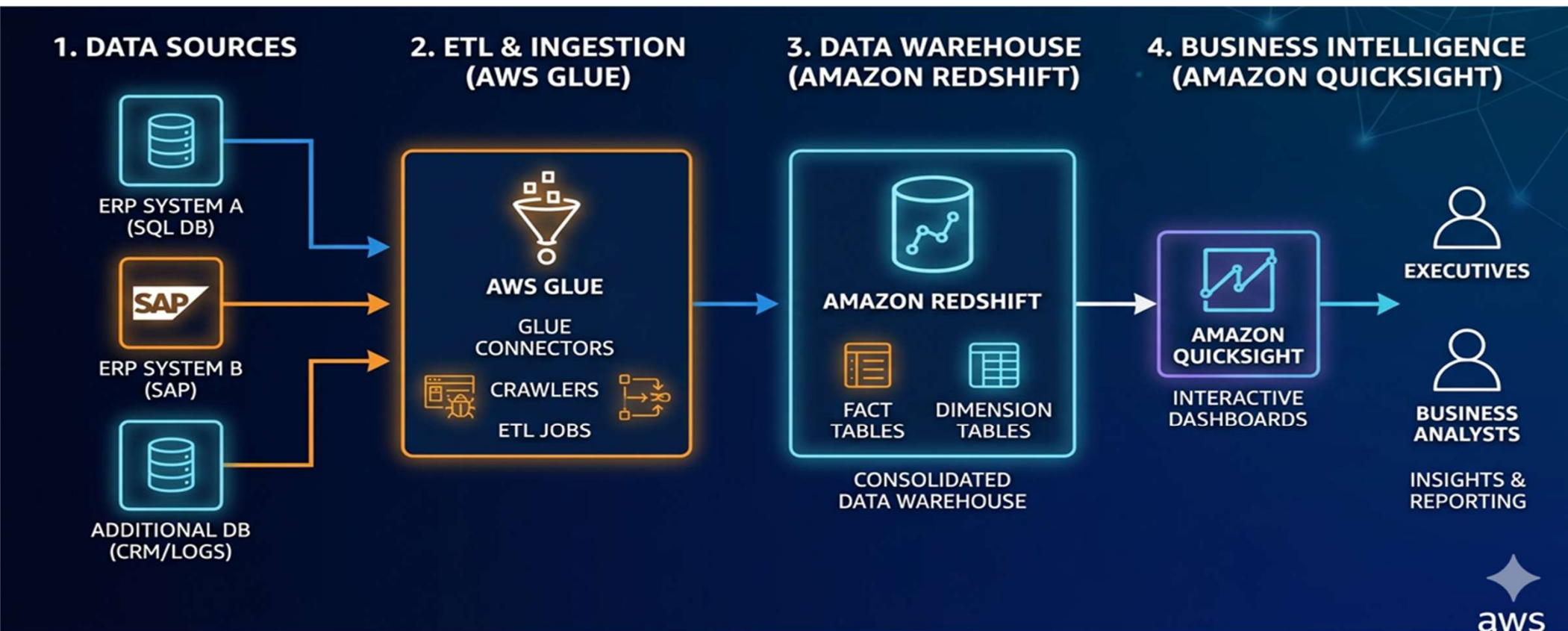


Amazon AWS | Overview and Vendor Stability

- Trusted by 80% of Fortune 500 companies
- Global Leader in Cloud Infrastructure
- Over 33% of market share in 2025



Amazon AWS | Product & Service Overview (The “Tech Stack”)



Amazon AWS | Additional Information



CUSTOMIZATION & INTEGRATION

- Connectivity to various databases.
- API-driven event refreshes.
- Hurdle: Technical mapping between distinct data models.
- Customization and Integration Challenges.



COST STRUCTURE

- Standard pay-as-you-go billing model.
- Specific costs for ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) implementation.
- Potential Hidden Costs: Data egress fees.
- Ongoing maintenance.



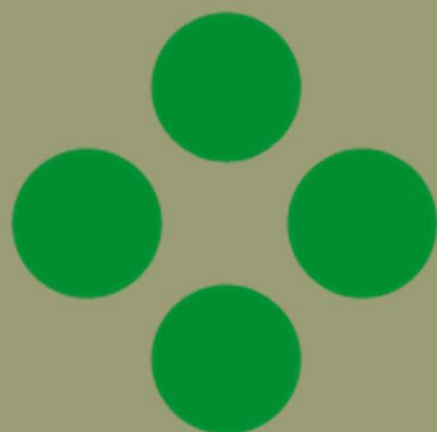
STRENGTHS & RISKS

- High level of technological maturity.
- Robust security infrastructure.
- Vendor considerations: Vendor lock-in.
- Technology & Vendor analysis.



USER EXPERIENCE (UX)

- Modern management interfaces.
- Natural Language Query (NLQ) capabilities for data discovery.
- Interactive dashboards & Canned reports.
- Designed for UX analysis.



crystal reports

SAP Crystal Reports | Company & Product Overview

VENDOR: SAP

- ▶ Founded 1972 — Germany
- ▶ Largest enterprise software providers globally
- ▶ Known for ERP, analytics & BI solutions

400K+

Organizations

1972

Est. Year

PRODUCT OVERVIEW

- ▶ Enterprise reporting tool for structured business reports
- ▶ Connects to ERP systems and SQL databases
- ▶ Converts raw data into formatted reports & insights

CORE CAPABILITIES

 **SQL Querying**

 **Custom Reports**

 **Data Visualization**

 **Scheduled Reports**

 **Export: PDF, Excel & More**

SAP Crystal Reports | Integration, Customization & Cost

INTEGRATION — Compatible Data Sources



ERP Databases



Cloud Warehouses



SQL Server / Oracle



Excel & Flat Files

Methods: ODBC/JDBC connections • .NET & Java APIs • SAP BusinessObjects Platform



CUSTOMIZATION

- ▶ Build SQL queries to extract ERP datasets
- ▶ Custom reports for Accounting & Property Mgmt
- ▶ Define KPIs & standardized report templates
- ▶ Role-based access control for users



COST STRUCTURE

\$495

per user license

- ▶ Implementation & config
- ▶ ERP integration
- ▶ Ongoing support

⚠ Hidden Costs: Consulting fees, infrastructure upgrades & training

SAP Crystal Reports | Strengths, Risks & Trial Experience

✓ STRENGTHS

- 🎯 **Highly Customizable**
- 🔗 **Strong SQL & DB Connectivity**
- 🏢 **Enterprise Financial Reporting**
- 🏆 **Mature & Widely Adopted**

⚠️ RISKS

- 🔒 **Vendor Lock-In**
- 📋 **Licensing Complexity**
- 💻 **Needs Technical Expertise**

🧪 TRIAL

30-Day
Free Trial Available

PROS (User Reviews)

- ✓ Powerful report formatting tools
- ✓ Strong SQL query capabilities
- ✓ Supports multiple enterprise DBs

CONS (User Reviews)

- ✗ Interface may feel outdated
- ✗ Steep learning curve for beginners

Final Recommendation | Microsoft Fabric

Why It's the Best Fit

- Strong alignment with reporting and analytics goals
- Works well with existing Microsoft tools and scalable for growth
- One unified platform reduces the need for multiple reporting tools reducing long-term costs

Key Considerations

- Pricing may increase as usage grows
- Staff may need training to use the platform effectively

Scale: 1 = Poor Fit | 2 = Weak Fit | 3 = Moderate Fit | 4 = Good Fit | 5 = Strong Fit

Criteria	Weights (%)	Microsoft Fabric	Databricks	AWS	SAP Crystal
<i>Strategic Alignment</i>	20	5	4	5	3
<i>Security & Compliance</i>	15	5	4	5	3
<i>Scalability</i>	15	5	5	5	3
<i>Integration with existing systems</i>	10	5	4	4	2
<i>User Experience</i>	10	4	3	4	3
<i>Implementation Timeline</i>	10	4	3	3	5
<i>Customization Flexibility</i>	5	3	4	5	2
<i>Vendor Stability/ Reputation</i>	5	5	4	5	5
<i>Change Management</i>	5	4	3	3	5
<i>Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)</i>	5	4	3	4	5
Total	100%	4.6	3.85	4.45	3.35